

SkyPath — Business Traveller Persona

Persona profile • UX research synthesis • Airline booking experience

Persona type	Primary / task-focused traveller
Primary context	Work-related domestic or international travel
Core motivation	Reach the destination reliably while minimising time and booking effort
Key priorities	Schedule, duration, reliability, fare clarity, flexibility, efficient booking
Typical behaviour	Compares a small set of viable options, then selects the best overall trade-off

Persona Snapshot

The business traveller approaches booking as a time-sensitive decision rather than an exploratory shopping activity. The goal is not simply to find the cheapest flight; it is to identify a reliable option that fits a constrained schedule and provides sufficient flexibility if plans change.

This persona is particularly sensitive to unnecessary steps, unclear fare conditions, hidden costs and interfaces that make important information difficult to locate. A strong experience should support rapid comparison while still providing enough detail to make a confident decision.

Goals

- Find suitable flights quickly within a fixed or narrow travel window.
- Compare departure time, arrival time, duration, stops and total cost.
- Understand what is included in each fare before committing.
- Complete passenger and payment details with minimal repetitive input.
- Make changes or access the itinerary easily when plans change.
- Maintain confidence that the final booking matches the intended itinerary.

Behaviours & Decision Patterns

- Starts with practical constraints such as date, destination and acceptable travel time.
- Uses comparison information to narrow choices rather than examining every available option.
- Values schedule quality and reliability alongside price.
- Looks for fare rules, baggage allowance and flexibility before final selection.
- Prefers predictable workflows and clear confirmation at consequential steps.
- May repeat bookings frequently, making remembered preferences and efficient data entry valuable.

Pain Points

- Search results that make meaningful differences between flights difficult to compare.
- Advertised prices that do not clearly communicate the final payable amount.
- Fare labels or benefits that require excessive interpretation.

- Repeated passenger-data entry and unnecessary form fields.
- Optional extras appearing as confusing or unexpected decisions.
- Weak confirmation states that make users uncertain whether the booking is complete.
- Difficulty retrieving or managing booking information after payment.

Needs from SkyPath

- A high-signal flight comparison experience.
- Transparent total pricing and fare inclusion details.
- Clear separation between essential booking decisions and optional extras.
- Efficient passenger information entry with sensible reuse of known data.
- Strong review and confirmation checkpoints.
- Fast access to itinerary, booking status and post-booking management.

Design Implications

The persona translates directly into product requirements. SkyPath should optimise for decision quality and task efficiency without hiding information that becomes important at the point of commitment.

Persona need	Design implication
Rapid comparison	Prioritise price, duration, stops, schedule and key fare information in search results.
Cost confidence	Expose total price and fare inclusions before payment.
Low interaction cost	Reduce repetitive data entry and unnecessary navigation.
Flexibility	Make change, cancellation and fare-condition information easy to find.
Booking confidence	Provide a clear review step and unambiguous confirmation state.
Post-booking access	Keep itinerary, booking status and management actions readily accessible.

Representative User Need

“Help me find a flight that fits my schedule, understand the real cost and fare conditions, and complete the booking without unnecessary steps or uncertainty.”

Role in the SkyPath Design

The Business Traveller acts as a primary task-efficiency persona for the SkyPath concept. The persona reinforces the project's focus on comparison clarity, transparent pricing, reduced friction, confidence during payment and accessible post-booking management. These needs inform the information architecture, task flows, wireframes and final interface decisions developed later in the case study.